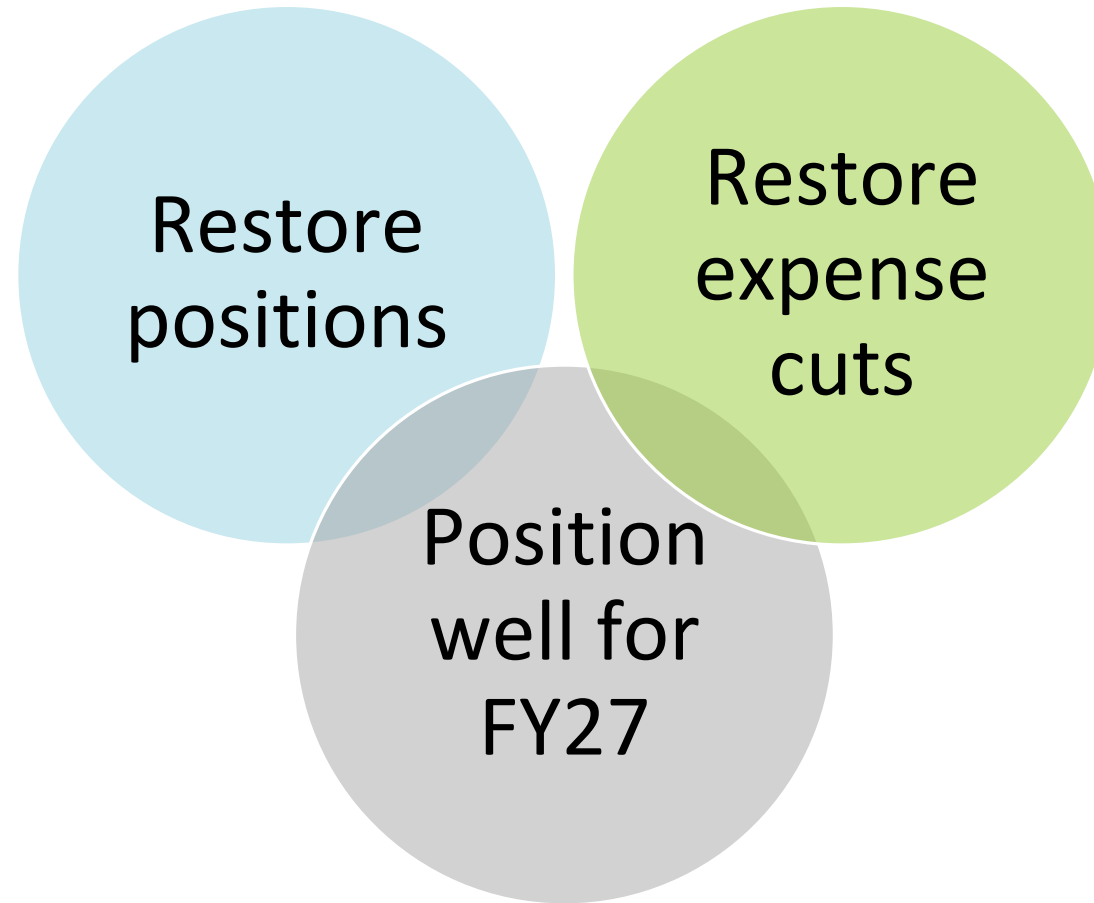


Free Cash FY26

Ways to Consider Using One Time Funds



Items Discussed by Principals

Positions

1. PE
2. LMHS Assistant Principal
3. Grade 5
4. LHS Math Teacher
5. LHS .4 Music
6. World Language
7. LHS Secretary
8. Athletic Secretary (PT)

Purchases

TouchView screens (Primary)
iReady diagnostic only (K-8)
IXL (9-12)
Lease/Purchase 2 vans

Restore Positions

PE teacher at LHS (\$82,609)

Returns 10 sections to the high school schedule; over 400 students signed up for PE courses 2025-26; graduation and state requirement to offer and pass PE; open enrollment course where students participate above the 1.5 required credits; provides more flexibility in the high school schedule.

Grade 5 teacher (\$97,230)

Provides equitable class size for all grade levels K-5; reduces class size for grade 5 allowing for more thorough interventions and small group work.

Math teacher at LHS (\$95,659)

Provides Unified Arts electives: coding , CAD, computer science.

Restore Expense Cuts

Restore iReady diagnostic (only) K-8 (\$14,835)

Provides data upon which to base instructional groupings and focus for individual interventions; documents student growth across a school year; can be used to document effectiveness of programs and interventions.

Position well for FY27 Budget and beyond

Business Manager position (\$10,000-20,000)

Add money to the budgeted position to attract a stronger qualified candidate

Consider hiring additional finance staff (\$TBD)

The demands of budget development have increased such that administration is engaged in intense and active budget development October-June.

Consider a consultant (\$TBD)

To assist the LMHS administration with ways to optimize the LMHS schedule; better utilize staff across 6-12; optimally place singletons to reduce conflicts for students

Unemployment Costs (\$TBD)

Supplement the unemployment line in the budget. Currently refining the list of staff who may be eligible to collect unemployment. We have a few resignations, retirements, and open positions and therefore not all cuts will result in unemployment claims. We are working with the LEA to finalize the list of their members as we need to factor in bumping rights and licenses. We will work with the Town Finance Director to determine an appropriate amount based on the actual list with salaries.

Supplement Athletic Budget Lines (\$TBD)

This will help the athletic revolving account to be restored to a positive balance; we are still operating in deficit.

Position well for FY27 Budget and beyond

Purchase TouchView screens for the Primary School (4 = \$10,400; 23 = \$59,800)

Currently the school has 2 touchview screens - 1 in 1st grade and 1 in 2nd grade (THES each classroom has a touchview). Touchviews have been critical to our educational initiatives but have unfortunately been removed from the budget over the past two years due to funding constraints. Touchviews are essential tools for enhancing the learning experience in our classrooms. These interactive displays offer a dynamic way for students to engage with educational content, making lessons more interactive, memorable, and effective. They are particularly valuable where hands-on learning and real-time feedback can significantly improve understanding and retention. Without these devices, we are limited in our ability to provide the best possible learning environment for our students, especially as educational technology continues to evolve. Our current resources, while functional, do not meet the growing demand for interactive learning in a tech-driven world. Research has shown that classrooms equipped with advanced technology like Touchviews see improved student performance, engagement, and enthusiasm for learning. This a one time purchase and this investment will serve us for years to come, enhancing both the teaching process and student outcomes.

Position well for FY27 Budget and beyond

Transport Vans; 15 passenger (\$65K) purchase; lease (\$TBD)

This is not a viable option

What is 7D Transportation?

Definition: 7D transportation, as defined in Massachusetts General Law Chapter 90, Section 7D, refers to the transportation of school pupils in vehicles that are not school buses but are used for transporting students.

Vehicle Type: These vehicles are typically passenger vehicles with a gross vehicle weight rating of 10,000 pounds or less, and they can have a **maximum of 11 seats**, including the driver.

Purpose: 7D vehicles are used to transport students to and from school, **extracurricular activities, or other school-related events.**

Transport Vans -Legal limitations and liability

Pursuant to state and federal law and regulations, fifteen-passenger vans do not comply with state or federal law for transportation of students to and from school and school-related activities. See, *49 United States Code §30112 and 540 CMR 7.09(1)*. See also generally, *School Pupil Transport Vehicles (7D)*, p.3., published by the Massachusetts Registry of Motor Vehicles, January 2023 (copy attached).

Federal law explicitly states that “a school or school system may not purchase or lease a new 15-passenger van if it will be used significantly by, or on behalf of, the school or school system to transport preprimary, primary, or secondary school students to or from school or an event related to school” *49 USCode §30112 (a)(2)*.

Transporting students in a 15-passenger van would potentially expose the District to increased liability; if transporting students is in fact a significant purpose of the District in acquiring such a vehicle, then any third party injured in the course of the District’s use of the vehicle might allege that the District was violating federal law in acquiring the vehicle, which could potentially affect the applicability and coverage of any insurance the District might have for injuries resulting from the use of the vehicle to transport students, and could also adversely affect the District’s ability to assert limitations on its liability under the Tort Claims Act and/or based on any release and indemnification provided by a student and/or parent.